



Open Data, Design, & Development at the Office of Natural Resources Revenue

Plain language on onrr.gov: coordination and implementation with web content owners

March 16, 2023

If you are a regular reader of our blog, you might already know that we recently completed a redesign of onrr.gov. This redesign included an update of the user interface. In addition, we focused on writing [accessible](#) content in accordance to the [Plain Writing Act of 2010](#). This blog post outlines the efforts we took to rewrite onrr.gov in plain language, as well as how we coordinated with content owners. We hope that other agencies can apply our strategies and lessons learned to their own websites.

Receiving a new product

In 2020, our Open Data, Design, and Development (ODDD) team started with managing and redesigning onrr.gov. We are a [small team](#), and taking on a new website in addition to maintaining and innovating on our Natural Resources Revenue Data (NRRD) [site](#) was a daunting task. We wrote about

how we adjusted to adding a product to our portfolio in a [previous blog post](#). Early user research and user-centered design techniques like [card sorting](#) and [tree testing](#) helped us get [stakeholder buy-in](#). This initial work allowed us to dive into rewriting content in plain language.

A note on getting buy-in

Our stakeholders already had experience working with us through our [508 compliance project](#) and participating in user research about [accessibility](#). These previous projects allowed our stakeholders to get to know our team, and we were able to build a rapport with them. Because of this, it was easy for us to get them on board with plain language concepts. It is also important to note that we have vocal support from our upper leadership to make accessibility a priority. Having buy-in from the top of our organization helps drive our team's projects. This support also helped our stakeholders understand that these changes align with our agency's goals and values.

Prototype

Our ODDD team does not own, and is not responsible for, the content on the website. During the initial prototype process, we worked with the content owners, or subject matter experts (SMEs), to reduce reading levels on their respective webpages. Instead of asking the SMEs to rewrite content themselves, our team did all the initial rewrites for every webpage. It was much easier to get SME participation by asking them to review and revise rather than asking them to start from scratch!

We proposed rewritten content that had lowered reading levels, with our goal being [grade 10](#). Within this rewritten content, we incorporated [plain language guidelines](#) like:

- Add useful headings
- Incorporate lists

- Incorporate tables and other visuals
- Write in simple words and phrases
- Write in short sentences and paragraphs
- Write in active voice and present tense
- Avoid jargon and abbreviations

After we sent the SMEs our proposed rewrites, they would review and revise. This became an iterative process, because the SME revisions would usually be over a grade 10 reading level and incorporate difficult language or jargon that we would need to edit again. In order to help the SMEs understand why we were rewriting in plain language, we used the free online version of [Hemingway Editor](#). At the time of this project, our agency's Microsoft products did not include the [Editor function](#). We recently got access and plan on also using this function in future work. Regardless of which function you have access to, using an unbiased software to evaluate the text helped us illustrate the readability issues that we wanted to resolve. Once the SMEs saw the Hemingway results, they were more willing to negotiate with us and work with our proposed changes.

Through this iterative process, we were able to reduce reading levels on all webpages compared to the old site. Because some of the content on the website is technical and not meant for the general public, not all pages got down to grade 10, but were still reduced. When we couldn't get the reading levels down to grade 10, we made sure the page contained other plain language concepts listed above.

Hemingway example: late payment interest

On the [late payment interest page](#), the text on the old website was at a grade 14 reading level. The text consisted of two long paragraphs with complex sentences as well as passive voice. On the right side of the webpage, there

was a green pop-up button that opened additional content. There was even more content lower on the page that required a significant amount of scrolling.

Late Payment Interest – old text

Bold Italic H1 H2 H3 Quote Bullets Numbers Link

Write Edit

The Federal Oil and Gas Royalty Simplification and Fairness Act of 1996 (RSFA), required ONRR to pay interest on Federal oil and gas royalty overpayments. On December 4, 2015, the Fixing America's Surface Transportation (FAST) Act was signed by the President. The FAST Act contained a provision that removed ONRR's authority to pay interest on Federal oil and gas overpayments. It has been interpreted that ONRR retained authority to pay interest which had accrued prior to the effective date of the FAST Act on December 4, 2015, but not for periods beyond that date. The RSFA and the FAST Act applies only to Federal oil and gas payments, not to payments for Indian, Solid mineral, and geothermal obligations.

The Federal Oil and Gas Royalty Management Act of 1982 requires underpayment interest to be charged on late payments or any underpayment due. Underpayment interest on solid mineral and geothermal leases is calculated as simple interest using the United States Treasury Current Value of Funds Rate. Underpayment interest on oil and gas leases is calculated as compound interest using the Internal Revenue Service underpayment rate for corporate tax payers. Overpayment interest on oil and gas leases is calculated as compound interest using the Federal short-term rate plus 2 percentage points.

Hemingway

Readability

Grade 14

Poor. Aim for 9.

Words: 210

Show More

adverbs. Well done.

uses of passive voice. Cut to 2 or fewer.

phrase has a simpler alternative.

of 9 sentences are hard to read.

of 9 sentences are very hard to read.

Late Payment Interest – old site

Late Payment & Underpayment Interest Tables

Policy

Production Reporting

Royalty Reporting

Solid Minerals Reporting

Payments

Forms

Late Payment Interest

Handbooks

Reporter Letters

Training

The Federal Oil and Gas Royalty Simplification and Fairness Act of 1996 (RSFA), required ONRR to pay interest on Federal oil and gas royalty overpayments. On December 4, 2015, the Fixing America's Surface Transportation (FAST) Act was signed by the President. The FAST Act contained a provision that removed ONRR's authority to pay interest on Federal oil and gas overpayments. It has been interpreted that ONRR retained authority to pay interest which had accrued prior to the effective date of the FAST Act on December 4, 2015, but not for periods beyond that date. The RSFA and the FAST Act applies only to Federal oil and gas payments, not to payments for Indian, Solid mineral, and geothermal obligations.

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Rates Used to Calculate Interest

The following table contains the interest rates used to calculate underpayment and overpayment interest.

Resources

Questions / Contact

Financial Services

(800) 433-9801

Interest Calculator

Interest Calculation

Sample Calculation

The revised text on our live site now has a grade 9 reading level, even though the required regulatory information is still present. We broke up the two complex paragraphs into smaller paragraphs. We also incorporated headings to make the contents easier to navigate. We eliminated the passive voice and created shorter, less complicated sentences. The additional information is now organized into separate tabs to reduce scrolling and remove confusing pop-up buttons.

Late Payment Interest – new text

BoldItalicH1H2H3QuoteBulletsNumbersLink

WriteEdit

Hemingway

Readability

Grade 9

Good

Words: 198

Show More

0adverbs. Well done.

0uses of passive voice. Nice work.

0phrases have simpler alternatives.

0of 16 sentences are hard to read.

0of 16 sentences is very hard to read.

Overview

Federal Oil and Gas Overpayments

The Federal Oil and Gas Royalty Simplification and Fairness Act of 1996 (RSEA) required ONRR to pay interest on federal oil and gas royalty overpayments. On December 4, 2015, the Fixing America's Surface Transportation (FAST) Act became law. The FAST Act removed ONRR's authority to pay interest on federal oil and gas overpayments. The interpretation of these acts is that ONRR has authority to pay interest accrued before December 4, 2015, but not after. Both acts apply only to federal oil and gas payments, not to payments for Indian, solid mineral, and geothermal obligations.

We calculate overpayment interest on oil and gas leases as compound interest. We use the federal short-term rate plus 2 percentage points.

Underpayments

The Federal Oil and Gas Royalty Management Act of 1982 requires us to charge underpayment interest. This applies to late payments and any underpayment due.

We calculate underpayment interest on oil and gas leases as compound interest. We use the Internal Revenue Service underpayment rate for corporate tax payers.

We calculate underpayment interest on solid mineral and geothermal leases as simple interest. We use the United States Treasury Current Value of Funds Rate.

Late Payment Interest – new site

HomePayingLate Payment Interest

Late Payment Interest

OverviewInterest RatesInterest Calculator

Overview

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Contact

Financial Services

1-800-433-9801

Hemingway example: dear reporter letters

The [dear reporter letters](#) is one of our most frequently used webpages. On the old site, the introductory text to this page was at a grade 14 reading level. Almost every sentence was complicated to read and contained difficult vocabulary. The focus of the page is a table containing the downloadable documents. The table had no way to sort or filter information. There was also no pagination, so the user had to scroll through a very long table.

Dear Reporter Letters – old text

BoldItalicH1H2H3QuoteBulletsNumbersLink

WriteEdit

Hemingway

Readability

Grade 14

Poor. Aim for 9.

Words: 92

Show More

2adverbs. Aim for 1 or fewer.

0uses of passive voice. Nice work.

2phrases have simpler alternatives.

2of 4 sentences are hard to read.

1of 4 sentences is very hard to read.

ONRR periodically sends Reporter Letters to active payors and reporters regarding important information such as system or procedural changes, deadlines, reporter training schedules, and updates to the Code of Federal Regulations.

The list of Reporter Letters is searchable by date or by word or words in the Subject line—it automatically sorts the list as you type in the Search field.

Note: In order to receive Reporter Letters, you must have at least one signed, original Form ONRR-4444 on file with us. The form and detailed instructions are on the [Forms](#) page.

Dear Reporter Letters – old site

An official website of the United States government

Office of Natural Resources Revenue

U.S. Department of the Interior

Revenue Data

HomeReporting/PayingValuationIndian ServicesComplianceAbout

Home / Reporter Letters

Reporter Letters

Policy

Production Reporting

Royalty Reporting

Solid Minerals

Reporting

Payments

Forms

Late Payment Interest

Handbooks

Reporter Letters

Training

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The list of Reporter Letters is searchable by date or by word or words in the Subject line—it automatically sorts the list as you type in the Search field.

Note: In order to receive Reporter Letters, you must have at least one signed, original Form ONRR-4444 on file with us. The form and detailed instructions are on the [Forms](#) page.

Select a Reporter Letter to view it.

Reporter Letter	Date
Termination of Navajo Nation Royalty In-Kind Program (signed)	04/18/2022
Termination of Navajo Nation Royalty In-Kind Program	
File Structure Change	01/25/2022
File Structure Change (accessible .pdf)	
Withdrawal of the 2020 Valuation Rule	10/21/2021
Extending the Deadline for 2016 Valuation Rule Compliance to 10/01/2020	
Extending the Deadline for 2016 Valuation Rule Compliance to 10/01/2020 (accessible .docx)	06/30/2020
Extending the Deadline for 2016 Valuation Rule Compliance to 07/01/2020	11/20/2019
Finalization of Federal and Indian Coal Provisions of the 2016 Consolidated Valuation	10/17/2019

On the new site, we simplified the introductory text to a grade 10 reading level. We made most sentences shorter with simpler vocabulary, while still

incorporating the necessary technical information. The table includes search and filter functions. A new topics column helps the user better understand what each letter is about, and these topics are also incorporated into the filter function. The table now also has pagination, so the amount of scrolling decreased.

Dear Reporter Letters – new text

Bold Italic H1 H2 H3 Quote Bullets Numbers Link Write Edit

We send reporter letters to active payors and reporters about important information. **This includes changes to systems or procedures, deadline notices, reporter training schedules, and regulation updates.**

We send reporter letters to addresses indicated on [Form ONRR-4444](#). If you don't receive them, submit a new [Form ONRR-4444](#).

You can search reporter letters by date or words in the subject line

Hemingway
Editor

Readability
Grade 10
OK, Aim for 9.

Words: 60
Show More

0 adverbs. Well done.

0 uses of passive voice. Nice work.

0 phrases have simpler alternatives.

0 of 5 sentences are hard to read.

1 of 5 sentences is very hard to read.

Dear Reporter Letters – new site

Home References Reporter Letters

Reporter Letters

We send reporter letters to active payors and reporters about important information. This includes changes to systems or procedures, deadline notices, reporter training schedules, and regulation updates.

We send reporter letters to addresses indicated on [Form ONRR-4444](#). If you don't receive them, submit a new [Form ONRR-4444](#).

You can search reporter letters by date or words in the subject line.

All Topics

Reporter Letters	Date	Topics
CMP PSR Electronic Reporting Revirement	8/17/2022	Electronic Reporting/Payments, Solid Minerals
Termination of Navajo Nation Royalty-in-Kind Program	4/18/2022	Indian Oil, Royalty In Kind, Tribes
Termination of Navajo Nation Royalty-in-Kind Program (accessible)		
File Structure Changes	1/28/2022	Federal Oil, Federal Gas
File Structure Changes (accessible)		
Withdrawal of the 2020 Valuation Rule	10/21/2021	Rulemaking, Federal Oil, Federal Gas, Federal Coal, Indian Coal, Civil Penalties
Extending the Deadline for 2014 Valuation Rule Compliance to 10/31/2020	6/30/2020	Rulemaking, Federal Oil, Federal Gas, Federal Coal, Indian Coal
Extending the Deadline for 2014 Valuation Rule Compliance to 10/31/2020 (accessible)		
Extending the Deadline for 2014 Valuation Rule Compliance to 07/31/2020	11/20/2019	Federal Coal, Federal Gas, Federal Oil, Indian Coal, Oil & Gas Revenue, Rulemaking
Enjoining of Federal and Indian Coal Provisions of the 2014 Consolidated Valuation	10/17/2019	Federal Coal, Indian Coal, Rulemaking, Solid Minerals
Assessment of Late Payment Charges on Solid Mineral Leases	6/24/2019	Payments, Solid Minerals
Reinstatement of the Consolidated Federal Oil & Gas and Federal A Indian Coal Valuation Rule	6/13/2019	Federal Coal, Federal Gas, Federal Oil, Indian Coal, Oil & Gas Revenue, Rulemaking, Solid Minerals
August 2018 Revised, Nationwide Gas Processing Contracts	8/21/2018	Contracts, Federal Gas, Indian Gas, Oil & Gas Production, Oil & Gas Revenue

Items per page: 10 1-10 of 181

Final design

After the iterative writing process with the SMEs was complete, they gave their approval on the finalized prototype of the website. We then developed the site using this finalized design and content. After we built the development site, our team requested an additional round of review by the SMEs. We made sure we had SME approval before finalizing a webpage, and we used a content tracking spreadsheet (pictured below, with the SME approval status column highlighted by a red box) to keep these approvals organized.

1	Sort On	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
			Status	Title	Type	Added By	Reviewed I	GitHub Iss	Commen	Hierarchy ID	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3
186	185	Approved by SME		Interest Calculator	tab	Dan	Shannon	1562		4.2.3	Paying	Late Payment Interest	Interest Calculator
187	186	Approved by SME		Unpaid Debt	page	Shannon	Christine	1251		4.3	Paying	Unpaid Debt	
188	187	Approved by SME		Contacts	page (dupl	Shannon	Christine	1461		4.4	Paying	Contacts	
189	188	Approved by SME		Troubleshooting	tab (duplicate content)	Christine		1530		4.4.1	Paying	Contacts	
190	189	Approved by SME		Contacts	tab (duplicate content)	Christine		1531		4.4.2	Paying	Contacts	
191	190	Approved by SME		Compliance & Enforcement (Home)	page	Maroya	Shannon	1246		5.0	Compliance & I	Compliance & Enforcement (Home)	
192	191	Approved by SME		Compliance	page	Shannon	Christine	1462		5.1	Compliance & I	Compliance	
193	192	Approved by SME		Overview	tab	Shannon	Christine	1463		5.1.1	Compliance & I	Compliance	Overview
194	193	Approved by SME		Compliance Authorities	tab	Christine	Shannon	1464 & 1946		5.1.2	Compliance & I	Compliance	Compliance Authorities
195	194	Approved by SME		Contacts	tab	Christine		1465		5.1.3	Compliance & I	Compliance	Contacts
196	195	Approved by SME		Enforcement & Litigation Support	page	Lindsay	Shannon	1466		5.2	Compliance & I	Enforcement & Litigation Support	
197	196	Approved by SME		Enforcement	tab	Lindsay	Shannon	1475		5.2.1	Compliance & I	Enforcement & Litigation Support	
198	197	Approved by SME		Civil Penalties	tab	Lindsay, Mar	Shannon, Chri	1476		5.2.2	Compliance & I	Enforcement & Litigation Support	Civil Penalties
199	198	Approved by SME		Bankruptcies & Litigation Support	tab	Lindsay	Shannon	1477		5.2.3	Compliance & I	Enforcement & Litigation Support	Bankruptcies & Litigation Support
200	199	Approved by SME		Contacts	tab	Christine		1478		5.2.4	Compliance & I	Enforcement & Litigation Support	Contacts
201	200	Approved by SME		Appeals	page	Lindsay	Shannon	1467		5.3	Compliance & I	Appeals	
202	201	Approved by SME		How to Appeal	tab	Lindsay	Shannon	1479		5.3.1	Compliance & I	Appeals	How to Appeal
203	202	Approved by SME		Sureties	tab	Lindsay, Shar	Shannon, Chri	1435		5.3.2	Compliance & I	Appeals	Sureties
204	203	Approved by SME		Past Decisions	tab	Lindsay	Shannon	1480		5.3.3	Compliance & I	Appeals	Past Decisions
205	204	Approved by SME		Contacts	tab	Shannon	Christine	1481		5.3.4	Compliance & I	Appeals	Contacts

The main challenge we encountered during this final design process was making sure the SMEs were communicating with each other. For most webpages, there was usually more than one SME reviewing and approving the content. We had to facilitate communication and coordination to make sure all SMEs involved in the process agreed with a decision.

An example of good coordination

We had one team who assigned one SME to be the point of contact/liaison with us. This SME would coordinate with everyone on their team and present all their asks to us as one unified voice. The SME would only contact us if there was a group question or when they had made a decision. This decreased the amount of time we needed to spend coordinating with the team and gave us more time to improve and innovate on their webpages.

What we learned from poor coordination

We thought another team had done something like this good example described above. Multiple SMEs from a team were invited to all the coordination meetings, but only one SME would attend, communicate with us, and recommend edits. At the final design stage, other SMEs decided they wanted more changes. As a result, major revisions took place at this final stage. This challenge lengthened the amount of time it took to finalize the language on the respective webpages. We assumed that since one SME took over, the other SMEs were in agreement. We learned that we should clearly

ask each team if there are any other SMEs that should be contributing, and to not make any assumptions!

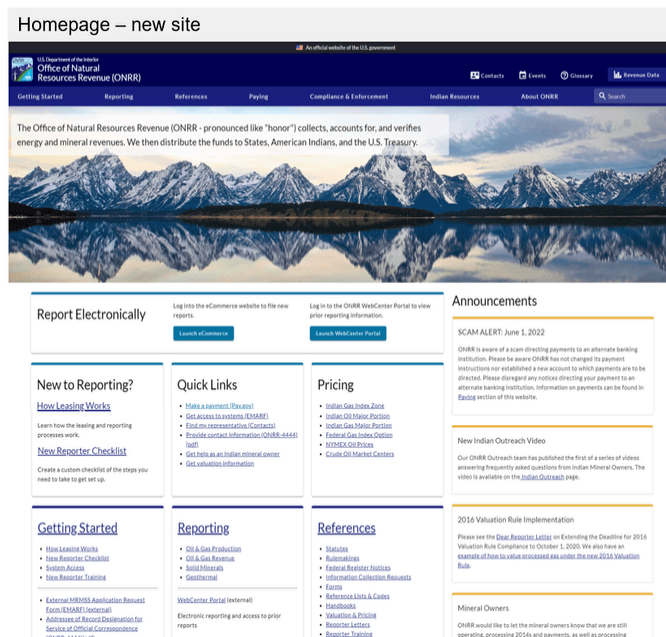
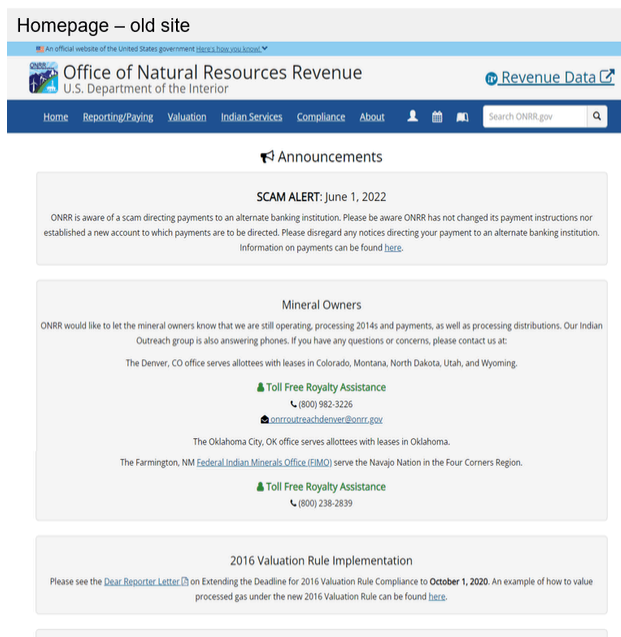
Before and after

Redesigning onrr.gov and making sure its content was accessible and written in plain language was a huge task! We are excited to share some of our favorite “before-and-afters” from this process.

Homepage

The old homepage required a significant amount of scrolling. It was extremely unclear what was important. The announcements took up the entire screen and scrolling was required to find other content.

On the new homepage, content is sorted into cards. The cards are also sorted by the level of use and importance. Using this card format breaks up the information into readable sections and reduces the amount of scrolling needed. Within the cards, content is organized using bulleted lists. Heading levels are also used to help with screen readers. The announcements are now on the right side of the page, so they don't take up the entire screen.



Contacts

On the old site, there was no single location to find all contacts. The user had to look through individual PDF, Word, and Excel documents that were all housed on different webpages. While we made sure that these contact documents were 508-compliant, finding them was still complicated.

Contacts – old site

 Contact Us

[Overview](#)

[Leadership](#)

[Office Locations](#)

[Rules & Regulations](#)

[Employment Opportunities](#)

[Press Releases](#)

[Natural Resources Revenue Data](#)

[Committees & Coordination](#)

[Freedom of Information Act](#)

[Presentations & Testimony](#)

[Anti-Harassment Program](#)

[Interacting with ONRR](#)

[Contact Us](#)

Search Table:

Accounts Receivable, Billing, and Financial Issues Information – Federal Oil, Gas, and Solid Minerals

Contacts Assigned by Company

Long distance: 1-800-433-9801, option 1, then extension
Denver local: 303-231-extension
Fax: 303-231-3501

ONRR Contacts

Topics	Contact	Online Resources
Making payments to ONRR	☎ (800) 433-9801 Ext. 3668	ONRR Contacts by Company Assignment: - Accounts Receivable, Billing, and Financial Information -- Federal - Accounts Receivable, Billing, and Financial Information -- Indian - Debt Collection - Company Assignment Additional Resources: - Payments - Appeals & Sureties - Civil Penalties
Submitting reports to ONRR	☎ (800) 433-9801	ONRR Contacts by Company Assignment: - Lease/Agreement Maintenance - Offshore Production Reporting - Onshore Production Reporting - Royalty Reporting and Error Correction Additional Resources: - Production Reporting (except for Solid) - Royalty Reporting (except for Solids) - Solid Minerals Reporting

Alphabetic Grouping or Company Name	Primary Contact	Phone Extension	Back-up Contact(s)	Phone Extension
Solid Minerals	Jonathan Nash (1) jonathan.nash@onrr.gov	None	Sabrina Tran sabrina.tran@onrr.gov	3541
I-A	Danielle Tempel (4) danielle.tempel@onrr.gov	3545	Deane LeBet deane.lebet@onrr.gov	3223 3441
B-BROWE	John O'Donoghue (4) john.o'donoghue@onrr.gov	3122	Edmond Osei Lu Croissant	3359 3451
BROWN-CHE	Deane LeBet (4) deane.lebet@onrr.gov	3223	Kush Mirchandani Danielle Tempel	3441 3545
CHI-DEC	Kush Mirchandani (4) kush.mirchandani@onrr.gov	3441	Danielle Tempel Deane Le Bet	3545 3223
DEE-ENERGYX	Jessica Sheets (1) jessica.sheets@onrr.gov	3401	Pola Vigil Katie Stewart	3428 3504
ENERGYQ-EXXE	Kathy Roach (2) kathy.roach@onrr.gov	3280	Felicia Carr Cherise Rahman	3192 3489
EXXO-GIF	Mark Moreno (2) mark.moreno@onrr.gov	3325	Kristina Woolums Kathy Roach	3197 3280

For the redesign, we created a database to house all contact information. Incorporating all contacts into one location allowed us to redesign the [contact us webpage](#) into a functional, searchable database. Within the main contacts webpage, the user can search all contacts within our agency. This main page is also organized by topic using the same card format seen throughout the site. Users can click the hyperlink within a topic card to navigate to an individual topic page. The individual topic pages have their own constrained search feature, where searches will only yield results relevant to that topic. The contact cards are organized with headings, which helps break down individual contact information.

Contact Us

Search Contacts

Search contacts by operator, payor, company name, or agency name.

I want to contact someone about or have a problem with:

Getting Started Learn about how the process works and what you need to do to get started reporting and paying.	System Access Troubleshoot issues with access to eCommerce and WebCenter Portal.	Leases & Agreements Get numbers and answers to questions about leases, agreements, and contracts.	Oil & Gas Production Get help reporting and correcting reports for oil and gas production.
Oil & Gas Royalty Get help reporting and correcting reports for oil and gas royalties.	Oil & Gas Rent Get help reporting, correcting reports, and paying rent and first year royalties.	Solid Minerals Get help reporting and correcting reports for solid minerals.	Geothermal Get help reporting and correcting reports for geothermal.
Payments & Debt Collection Get help making and correcting payments. Includes Accounts Receivable contacts.	Updating Contact Info Update the contact information on file (Form OIHR-4444) with OIHR for your company.		

Oil & Gas Production Contacts

Troubleshoot frequently asked production questions below. If your question isn't answered, contact us or visit the [Oil & Gas Production Reporting](#) section.

Troubleshooting **Contacts**

Contacts

Onshore Production Offshore Production

Onshore Production

Onshore production specialists can answer questions related to:

- Onshore federal production
- Indian production
- Electronic reporting problems

For royalty issues, see [Royalty Contacts](#).

Displaying 5 of 31 contacts

< 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 >

Companies starting with: #		
Primary Contact Kassandra Perry kassadeperry@onrr.gov 202-221-3181	Back-up Contact Christen Wiggins christenwiggins@onrr.gov 202-221-3243	Supervisor Linda Miller linda.miller@onrr.gov 202-221-3482
Companies starting with: A		
Primary Contact Wes Aboulsameer	Back-up Contact Johnny Ene	Supervisor Sonny Beaumont

Indian Energy Service Center

Note : On onrr.gov, we use the term "Indian" instead of "Native American" to be consistent with the usage by the Bureau of Indian Affairs.

Indian resources are also frequently visited webpages. The [Indian Energy Service Center](#) is one of these resource pages and is a very important page for stakeholders. On the old site, the text has a post-graduate reading level; the text was complicated with lot of acronyms. The right side of the webpage was confusing with several types of information jumbled together. The old page also required scrolling to find information.

On the new site, this page is organized within a tab series that includes all options for assistance. Within the Indian Energy Service Center tab, the text is now at a grade 11 reading level. The amount and frequency of agency names required in the text kept this reading level higher than we would like. To offset this, we organized the text with headings and bulleted lists, and incorporated simpler vocabulary whenever possible. We also divided information into tabs, with a separate tab for referral information. The right side is organized into more readable card styles with appropriate headings.

Indian Energy Service Center – old site

An official website of the United States government [Skip to main content](#)

Office of Natural Resources Revenue
U.S. Department of the Interior

Home Reporting/Paying Valuation Indian Services Compliance About

Search ONRR.gov

Indian Energy Service Center - IESC

[Allottee Assistance](#)
[FIMO](#)
[IESC](#)
[Tribal Assistance](#)
[Tribal Consultation](#)

The Indian Energy Service Center (IESC) is a multi-agency collaboration between the Bureau of Indian Affairs (BIA), Bureau of Land Management (BLM), Office of Natural Resources Revenue (ONRR), and Bureau of Trust Fund Administration (BTFA) whose mission is to expedite Indian oil and gas activities, standardize processes, and provide for multi-disciplinary engagement in support of gaining efficiencies in the management of all types of Indian Energy, Renewable Energy, and Mineral development and activities to better serve Indian beneficiaries and Tribes.

The IESC was created through a recommendation from an Indian Energy and Minerals Steering Committee (IEMSC) subcommittee to address the growing backlog at Agencies due to the increased activity in various parts of Indian country. Approved by the Assistant Secretary of Indian Affairs, the IESC received federal funding in FY2016 and has in-house staff from BIA, BLM, ONRR and BTFA.

Purpose

Support and streamline Interior's Indian energy development business process employed in the dozens of interior field offices across the country that manages all types of Indian energy, renewable energy, and mineral leasing and development activities. These field offices operate under varying interpretations of applicable requirements, input and output complicated program information to numerous other processing offices, and are regularly overwhelmed by surging workloads. The federal offices included in the IESC structure, BIA, BLM, ONRR, and BTFA, are those that directly manage and process all types of the Federal government's Indian energy, renewable energy, and mineral leasing activities and within which the aforementioned interior field offices exist.

Mission

Streamline business processes to efficiently develop the Indian mineral estate while protecting trust assets by removing barriers to all types of energy, renewable energy, and mineral development on Indian lands.

Principles

"Quality of Life, Stewardship, Accountability, and Beneficiary Focus"

Each of the four principles was a collaboration of principles from each of the four agencies

Announcement

ONRR would like to let the mineral owners know that we are still operating, processing 2014s and payments, as well as processing distributions. Our Indian Outreach group is also answering phones. If you have any questions or concerns, please call us at the numbers below.

Contacts

[IESC staff and related contacts](#)

Referrals

[Work Referral Information](#)

IESC Video Overview

[Overview of IESC](#)

Additional Information

If you would like to learn more about the IESC, have any questions, or would like to request a training, please email: IndianEnergyServiceCenter@bia.gov

Indian Energy Service Center – new site

Assistance

Choosing Assistance Tribal Assistance Indian Outreach Federal Indian Minerals Office **Indian Energy Service Center** Contacts

Indian Energy Service Center (IESC)

About Referral Information

About

The Indian Energy Service Center (IESC) is a collaboration between four agencies. The agencies representing the IESC are: Bureau of Indian Affairs (BIA), Bureau of Land Management (BLM), Office of Natural Resources Revenue (ONRR), and Bureau of Trust Fund Administration (BTFA).

Mission

Streamline business processes to efficiently develop the Indian mineral estate while protecting trust assets by removing barriers to all types of energy, renewable energy, and mineral development on Indian lands.

History

The Indian Energy and Minerals Steering Committee (IEMSC) recommended the creation of the IESC. The purpose of the IESC is to address the growing backlog at agencies due to the increased activity in various parts of Indian country. Approved by the Assistant Secretary of Indian Affairs, the IESC received federal funding in FY 2016 and began hiring staff from BIA, BLM, and ONRR.

The Service Center Director reports to the BIA Deputy Bureau Director – Trust Services of BIA. Each agency has an onsite branch chief who oversees the duties of the employees from their agency. The four branches of the IESC are:

- Real Estate Services (BIA),
- Engineering Services (BLM),
- Mineral Services (ONRR) and
- Beneficiary Services (BTFA).

Principles

Each of the four principles was a collaboration of principles from each of the four agencies represented at the IESC.

 Quality of Life

IESC Video Overview

[IESC Video Overview \(YouTube\)](#)

Contact

To learn more about the IESC, ask questions, or request training, please contact us.

720-593-2000
IndianEnergyServiceCenter@bia.gov

[All Indian contacts and staff directory](#)

Visiting the IESC office

How leasing works

We also added new webpages to the site that were not on our old site. Most of the new content focuses on educating the user to help them find what they need, understand what they find, and use what they find to meet their needs. A good example of this is the new [how leasing works webpage](#). This page walks a new user through the leasing process. The text is written at a grade 10 reading level. We incorporated images, headings, and tabs to organize information. We kept the text entries to short sentences and paragraphs.

How Leasing Works

The Office of Natural Resources Revenue (ONRR) manages the revenue from leases of federal and Native American land.

Lease Creation



The Bureau of Ocean Energy Management (BOEM) manages offshore leasing and the Bureau of Land Management (BLM) manages onshore leasing. BOEM and BLM award leases through a competitive bidding process. The Bureau of Indian Affairs (BIA), in consultation with BLM, manages leases on Native American lands.

Lease Management

After the lease is created, ONRR collects and distributes funds, checks for compliance and shares information with the public.

Collecting & Disbursing Funds

Achieving Compliance

Reporting & Sharing Information

Collecting & Disbursing Funds



Each month, companies report data to ONRR on the resources they produced. This includes the amount produced, the value of their production, and the amount of royalties they owe.

Oil and gas companies are required to submit two key monthly reports to ONRR. The first report is the Oil and Gas Operations Report (OGOR). It specifies the total production and disposition of oil and gas. The second report is the Report of Sales and Royalty Remittance (Form ONRR-2014). It specifies royalties due based on sales or use of the production.

Solid minerals companies are only required to submit one monthly report. The Production and Royalty (P&R) Report

Conclusion

Incorporating plain language guidelines within a website can be a difficult task, especially if you are not the content owner. Do not ask the content owner to make the first rewrite attempt. Instead, do that initial rewrite yourself and provide them with a draft to review. Using unbiased websites like Hemingway Editor is a great way to help SMEs understand how and why their text needs revision. This writing process can become iterative. Clear communication and coordination are needed to make it successful. Making sure there is buy-in at the beginning of a project will help this process.

When rewriting, we focused on lowering reading levels. Most of the old text was between grade 13 and postgraduate reading levels. Even though our site

is not for the general public, the overall reading level was too high. Incorporating plain language guidelines helped us bring the reading levels down to grade 10 on most webpages.

Plain language encompasses not just the text within a webpage, but also the overall design. Including headings, tabs, bulleted lists, tables, and images are great ways to incorporate plain language concepts when it is necessary to keep technical text. Whenever we could not get reading levels down to grade 10, we made sure to incorporate other design concepts to ensure the webpage was easy to understand and navigate.

Our future content audits will include analysis of reading level and incorporation of plain language guidelines. We will continue to improve and strive to keep onrr.gov up to date with accessibility requirements.

Note : Reference in this blog to any specific commercial product, process, or service, is for the information and convenience of the public, and does not constitute endorsement, recommendation, or favoring by the Department of the Interior.



Christine Thomas: Content Strategist at the Office of Natural Resources Revenue. [Contact Christine.](#)

< [The U.S. Web Design System \(USWDS\) and onrr.gov](#)

[Modernizing a federal government website with user-centered design](#) >

[Home](#)



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From the team that works on Natural Resources Revenue Data and ONRR.gov. Have feedback or a blog post idea? Drop us a line.

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